

REDUCING LGBTQ+ BARRIERS TO CARE AT ATRIUM HEALTH THROUGH ONLINE TEAMMATE EDUCATION

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BACKGROUND

Research has identified that LGBTQ+ individuals who live in the United States experience discrimination when seeking healthcare services. The impact of discrimination has led LGBTQ+ patients to avoid seeking healthcare for routine preventative care services as well as delay in care for acute or chronic conditions. LGBTQ+ patients experience health disparities consistent of higher rates of HIV and other STIs; lower rates of mammography and pap smear screening; higher rates of substance abuse; higher rates of unhealthy weight; higher rates of tobacco use; higher rates of depression, anxiety and suicide; and higher rates of violent victimization.

OBJECTIVE

Educate Atrium Health Teammates on LGBTQ+ patient populations

METHODS

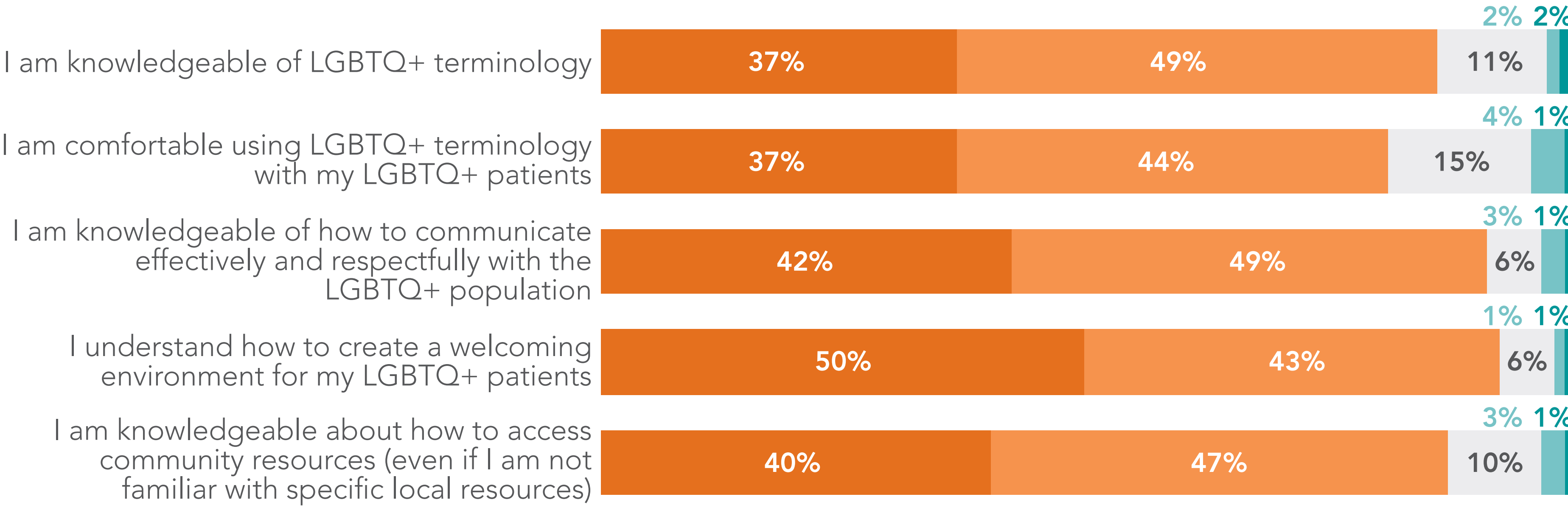
The online learning module was created to provide and enhance teammates knowledge and understanding of LGBTQ+ patients. Three focus groups were done consistent of teammates to review the module and provide feedback prior to the final edits and launch of the module.

The module is a twenty-minute interactive platform consistent of videos and questions with specific goals and objectives. There is a posttest survey to assess comfort regarding the subject matter that teammates can take to obtain CME/CEU credit.

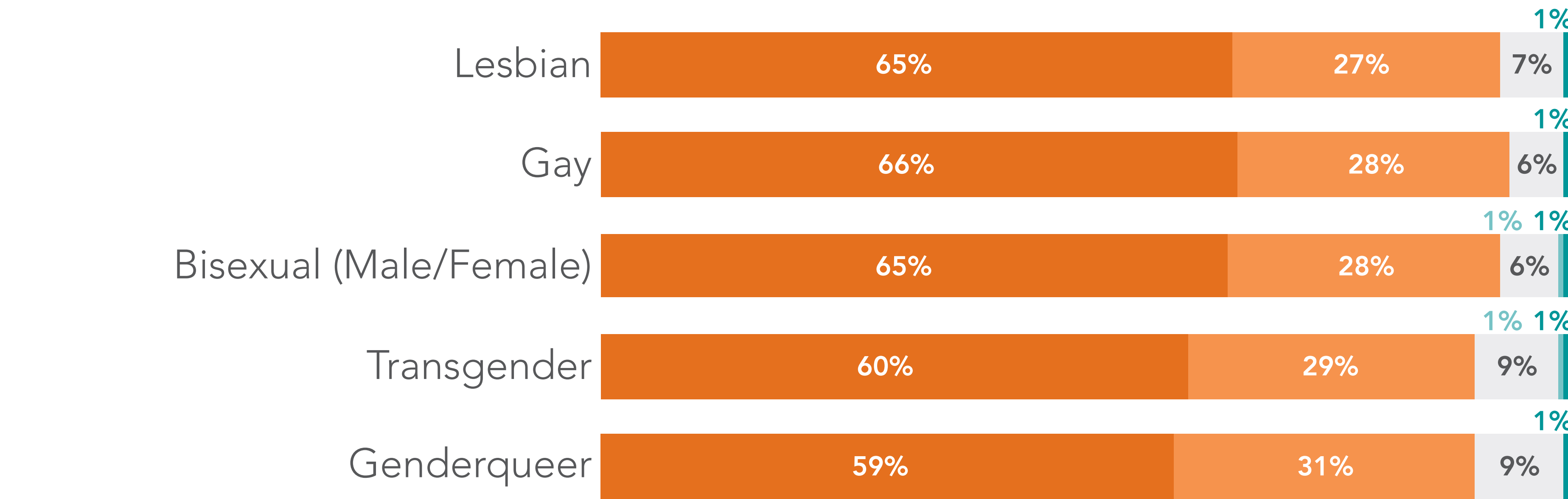
SURVEY QUESTION RESPONSES

Strongly Agree Agree Neutral Disagree Strongly Disagree

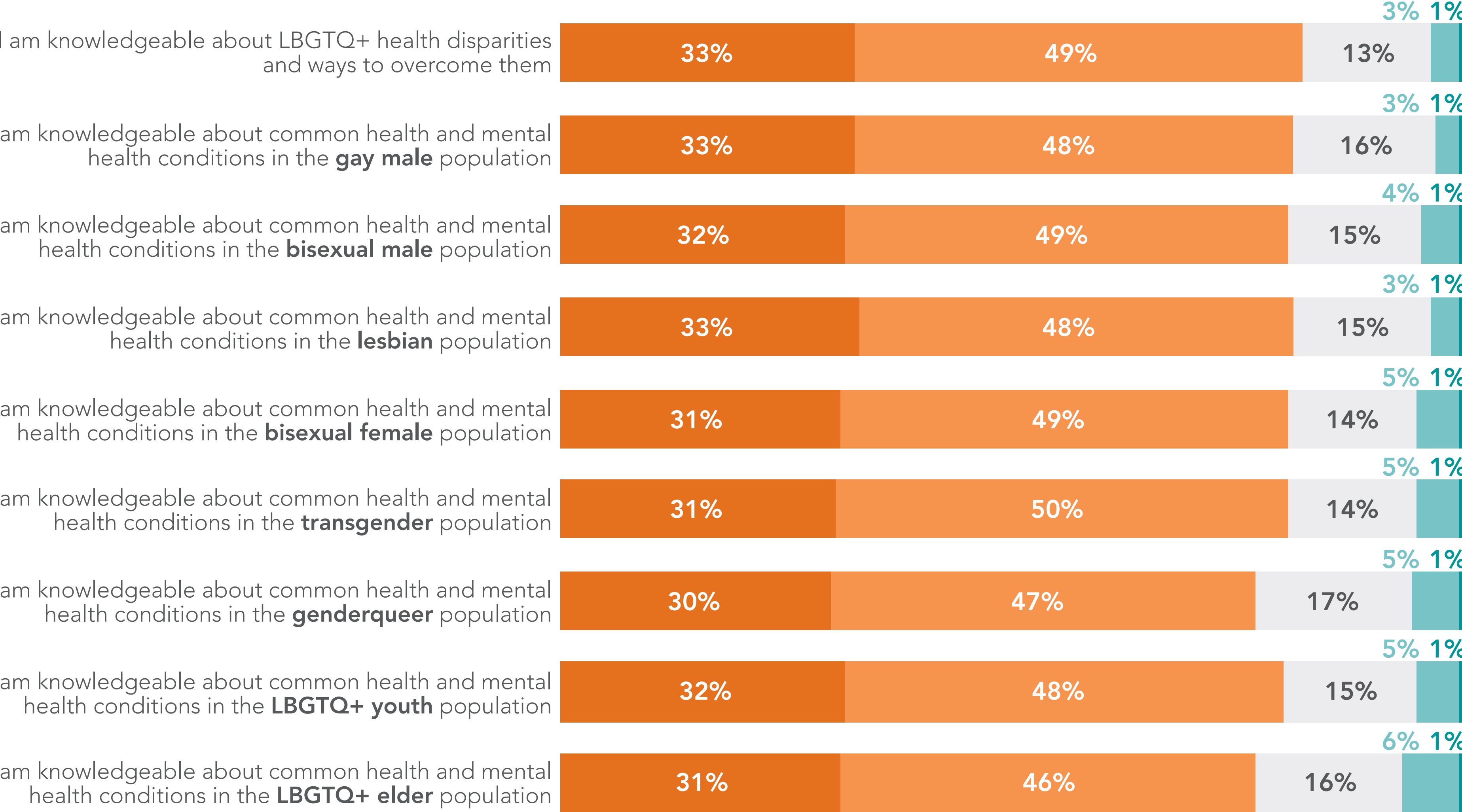
1. Please rate your general comfort level and knowledge of this subject.



2. I am comfortable caring for the following groups of people:



3. Please rate your specific knowledge level of medical and mental health issues.



RESULTS

One hundred and ninety-seven teammates have taken the online module (Sept 5, 2018 to February 8, 2019). Teammates completed a post module survey regarding general comfort level and knowledge of this subject on average scored 41.2% strongly agree vs 1.2% strongly disagree. Comfort with caring for LGBTQ+ patients was an average of 63% strongly agree vs 1% strongly disagree. However, knowledge level of medical and mental health issues was an average of 31.7% strongly agree vs 1% strongly disagree. The comments over all were supportive and provided gratitude for having an LGBTQ+ learning module.

"This course was wonderfully informative. As a LGBTQ+ teammate I would like to see this course as one of the required ACE module curriculum. Its very important for all healthcare providers to be knowledgeable about the issues we face."

"I do not provide patient care, but through this course I have gained more knowledge about how to interact respectfully and how to be more inclusive with LGBTQ+ persons in the workplace and in my personal life."

CONCLUSION

Education of the specific needs of LGBTQ+ patients and creating an inclusive affirming environment helps to reduce the inequities and disparities experienced by this patient population. The results are very positive as teammates voluntarily took the module. The feedback provided was from those who identified within the LGBTQ+ community or had an interest in learning more about this patient population. There will need to be a larger sample size of teammates to confirm if the data trend is consistent among teammates within Atrium Health.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS:

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